

Enterprise QA Delivery Lifecycle

A governed path from business need through production validation, stabilization, and measurable improvement.

PORTFOLIO ARTIFACT QS-01	SCOPE Enterprise Salesforce Delivery	EDITION Sanitized / Generalized
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PURPOSE
Define when quality work begins, what evidence is required at each checkpoint, who owns the next decision, and when work is ready to advance.

End-to-End Lifecycle

Quality is treated as a delivery system rather than a final test phase.

DISCOVER & DEFINE	1 Business Request	2 Story Design	3 Three-Amigos Refinement	4 Backlog Refinement
PLAN & BUILD	5 Ready Checkpoint	6 Sprint Planning	7 Build + QA Prep	8 Ready for QA
VERIFY & ACCEPT	9 QA Execution	10 QA Completion	11 UAT / Business Acceptance	
RELEASE & IMPROVE	12 Staging + Release	13 Production Validation	14 Stabilize + Close	

Core Operating Principles

PRINCIPLE	WORKING RULE
Quality begins at definition	The business problem, expected outcome, rules, users, data, and risk are clarified before implementation.
Requirements must be testable	Acceptance criteria describe observable behavior, including positive, negative, boundary, permission, validation, and failure paths.
Development and QA prepare in parallel	Test data, roles, environments, integration observations, and regression scope are prepared while development is active.
Status follows evidence	Work advances because entry/exit conditions are satisfied—not because of optimism or schedule pressure.
UAT validates business usefulness	Functional QA should be complete enough that UAT focuses on realistic operational acceptance.
QA reports evidence and residual risk	QA provides the outcome and risk picture; authorized business and release stakeholders make final acceptance and release decisions.

Phase Model: Discover, Define, Plan, and Build

#	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	EVIDENCE / OUTPUT
1	Business Request	Define the problem, intended outcome, users, urgency, systems, risks, and accountable business owner.	Problem/outcome statement; scope; risk/dependency notes
2	Story Design	Translate the business need into specific behaviors, rules, data needs, roles, and measurable scenarios.	Story; scenarios; rules; data/role notes
3	Three-Amigos Refinement	Align business/product, development, and QA perspectives; expose ambiguity and technical/test risk.	Updated criteria; decisions; open questions
4	Backlog Refinement	Confirm scope, sizing, dependencies, sequencing, environments, data, and specialist needs.	Refined story; estimate; dependency/test notes
5	Ready Checkpoint	Verify the work meets the team's Definition of Ready before sprint commitment.	Ready decision; unresolved actions
6	Sprint Planning	Balance full-team capacity and sequence work so QA receives a steady, testable flow.	Sprint goal; backlog; capacity and test plan
7	Build + QA Preparation	Implement approved scope while QA prepares coverage, data, access, integrations, and regression scope.	Implementation evidence; test design; deployment notes
8	Ready for QA	Confirm peer review, correct build, self-test evidence, data/services, version notes, and known limitations.	Accepted QA handoff or documented rejection

CHECKPOINT RULE

A status change is a claim that the required evidence exists. If a prerequisite is missing, return the work to the responsible stage with the gap, owner, and next action documented.

Phase Model: Verify, Accept, Release, and Improve

#	PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	EVIDENCE / OUTPUT
9	QA Execution	Execute acceptance scenarios plus risk-based positive, negative, boundary, validation, permission, integration, data, and regression checks.	Test results; evidence; defects; coverage status
10	QA Completion	Assess coverage, unresolved defects, skipped/blocked areas, limitations, and residual risk.	Pass / Pass with Risk / Conditional Pass / Fail / Blocked
11	UAT / Business Acceptance	Business users validate realistic operational workflows with representative roles and data.	Accepted / Conditional / Rejected / Deferred decision
12	Staging + Release Readiness	Validate the combined candidate, deployment path, configuration, monitoring, rollback, and critical journeys.	Staging evidence; residual risk; Go/No-Go input
13	Production Validation	Deploy the approved candidate, run controlled non-destructive smoke tests, and monitor critical service health.	Deployment record; smoke results; monitoring evidence
14	Stabilize + Close	Resolve follow-up issues, preserve evidence, update regression assets, review metrics, and create owned improvements.	Closure record; metrics; retrospective actions

Quality Gates

GATE	MINIMUM EVIDENCE
STORY READY	Business outcome/owner clear; measurable criteria; scope boundaries; roles/data/integrations; dependencies visible; work small enough to complete.
READY FOR QA	Peer review complete; correct build deployed; developer checks passed; data/services available; version and limitations documented; QA assigned.
QA COMPLETE	Critical scenarios assessed; regression completed; defects current; blocked areas disclosed; evidence preserved; residual risk and QA outcome recorded.
RELEASE READY	QA and UAT decisions recorded; candidate matches approved scope; staging checks complete; rollback/monitoring ready; known risk accepted by authorized owner.

Decision Boundaries and Leadership Controls

ROLE	PRIMARY ACCOUNTABILITY
Product / Business	Own business value, priority, scope decisions, operational acceptance, and authorized risk decisions.
Business Analyst	Own requirement clarity, process logic, business scenarios, traceability, and decision support.
Development	Own technical design, implementation, peer review, developer testing, correction support, and deployment notes.
Quality Assurance	Own testability, coverage, execution, evidence, defect reporting, risk assessment, and QA outcome.
UAT Owner	Own real-world workflow validation and formal business acceptance.
Release / Operations	Own candidate control, deployment, rollback, monitoring, incident handling, and stabilization evidence.

Measures That Matter

- Flow: cycle time, wait time for QA/UAT, correction time, carryover, Ready-for-QA rejection rate, environment downtime.
- Testing: planned vs. executed coverage, blocked coverage, reopen rate, regression depth, UAT rejection rate.
- Product quality: escaped defects, incidents, change failure rate, rollbacks, hotfixes, repeat defects.
- Requirement quality: refinement rejection, post-commit acceptance changes, missing-data/dependency failures.
- Release health: staging failures, deployment duration, production validation failures, stabilization incidents, time to recovery.

PORTFOLIO SANITIZATION NOTE

This portfolio edition is a generalized adaptation of an enterprise quality operating model. Institutional names, logos, internal ticket identifiers, personnel, URLs, environment names, proprietary fields, and implementation-specific details have been removed or generalized. The artifact is presented to demonstrate quality engineering method, governance, and leadership practice.